

The EU AI Act is written. The hard part is making it real.

5 takeaways from IAPP's AI Governance Global Europe 2026 — where the law stops and implementation begins.

Sovereignty is the new priority.

With the AI Act behind them, EU policymakers have pivoted to **AI sovereignty** — compute, capital, energy. Not protectionism. An assertion of democratic agency over technology that is never neutral.

● ● ● europe – strategic priorities

compute & infrastructure

scaling

capital & investment

scaling

European values

embed by design

↳ a rights-based framework as a competitive differentiator.

Past the law. Into the work.

The conversation moved past "**what the Act says**" to **how to do it** — assurance, auditing agentic systems, procurement, copyright. The recurring lesson: governance **cannot be siloed**.

● ● ● compliance – is the box checkable?

general counsel

needs technical fluency

AI engineer

needs legal fluency

↳ "legal pros must get comfortable in technical territory – and vice versa."

Shadow AI is the new frontier.

Adoption is no longer centralised. Teams deploy ahead of governance; staff expense AI subscriptions off the books. The fix isn't to slow innovation — it's to **distribute governance as fluidly as innovation.**

● ● ● shadow-ai — risk register

undocumented models	flagged
inconsistent standards	flagged
liability gaps	flagged
eroded human oversight	flagged

↳ shift left · spread expertise · build communities of practice.

It's really about the standards.

High-risk timelines moved to **Dec 2027** — still not much runway. **Harmonised standards** will define what compliance actually means, and they need more technical SMEs at the table.

● ● ● eu-ai-act — what's next

high-risk obligations

2 Dec 2027

harmonised standards

in development

AI literacy + AI Office role

enhanced

↳ technical experts wanted — faster, more useful standards.

The community is the infrastructure.

The regulations will evolve. The technology will evolve faster. What endures is the network of people who know what they've tried, what's failed, and what they wish they'd known sooner.

**Anyone can
cite the Act.**

**Few can
operationalise it.**

The gap in this field isn't legal knowledge. It's people who can sit between legal and engineering, distribute guardrails into the workflow, and learn out loud with the community. That overlap is rare — and it's where I work.

IF YOU'RE WORKING IN THIS SPACE

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Privacy → data protection & AI governance · Berlin

GDPR operations · EU AI Act readiness · ISO/IEC 42001 ·
NIST AI RMF · CIPP/E & AIGP in progress. I bridge the
legal text and the implementation.

Let's talk →

Source: IAPP – "Notes from the AI Governance Center: AIGG Europe 2026" by Ashley Casovan.

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08